



Trump ramps up pressure on media

He signals plans to use all levers of power against journalists

BY SARAH ELLISON AND JEREMY BARR

For many years, Donald Trump repeatedly threatened to sue the press but often didn't follow through. When he did, he almost always lost.

But Trump's recent settlement with ABC News and a cascade of lawsuits and other complaints against media entities from him and his allies signal a ramped-up campaign from the president-elect. Together, the action has spurred concerns that his efforts could drastically undermine the institutions tasked with reporting on his coming administration, which Trump has promised will take revenge on those he perceives as having wronged him.

"The law in this country hasn't really changed, but what has changed is that the atmosphere and hostility to the press is intense, and that emboldens plain-tiffs of all kinds," said David Korzenik, a media defense lawyer at the boutique Miller Korzenik Sommers Rayman LLP.

The pressure from Trump and his allies on the media is already growing and will continue to intensify, according to two Trump aides who spoke on the condition of anonymity to share sensitive internal deliberations.

In the two months before the presidential election, Trump at-

SEE TRUMP ON A4



ANNA WATTS FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

In Ariz., clinging to compassion

'A genuinely good person' fights the waves of anger and resentment after the election

It was the kind of day that Cydni Irving liked most. The kind of day where she could be the best version of herself, which was how she was feeling when she arrived to set up her table in the park, in the best version of Kingman that she knew: clear sky, sun, the Hualapai Mountains stretching out behind her, and on the table in front of her, a stack of fliers for the program where she worked, helping people in need.

Cydni stood at her table and smiled. She was there for a resource fair for poor families in Mohave County, the rural desert of northwest Arizona where she had spent her life. All around the park on this Wednesday in November, there were mental health counselors, free clothes and free

BY RUBY CRAMER IN KINGMAN, ARIZ.

Cydni Irving with her daughter Ariel at home. Irving describes her view of the world as humanitarian.

Narcan kits. Across the street, three motel rooms waited with showers and towels. And to Cydni's left, another table was already set up.

It belonged to a church in town that she knew to be conservative. There were plenty of those in Kingman, but now she heard what the people at the table were saying.

"Did you see how much God changed everything?" one said.

"God saved us by sending Trump." Her colleague told her: "Cydni, don't pay attention."

She told herself: "Cydni, don't say anything."

But it was becoming harder to stop

SEE KINGMAN ON A6

Many pardon hopefuls languish

BIDEN CRITICIZED AS HUNTER BENEFITS

Bipartisan outcry over prisoners awaiting action

BY BETH REINHARD, ANN E. MARIMOW AND PERRY STEIN

When President Joe Biden signed a sweeping pardon for his son this month, he sidestepped the Justice Department's rigorous vetting process for people seeking clemency.

Meanwhile, the president kept waiting hundreds of clemency applicants whom the department had recommended to the White House months and even years earlier, according to multiple people familiar with the clemency process who spoke on the condition of anonymity to divulge sensitive information.

Amid the blowback over Hunter Biden's pardon, Biden soon announced almost 1,500 commutations, in what the White House touted as the "largest single-day grant of clemency in modern history." Like Biden's son, those people were not individually vetted by the Justice Department, which carefully considers the circumstances of each case before issuing a recommendation. A Pennsylvania judge accused of taking pay-offs in exchange for sending children to juvenile detention made the list, sparking another outcry.

The mass commutation benefited only those who had been

SEE BIDEN ON A2

Palestinian Authority battles an internal foe

West Bank group hopes fight for camp will boost its case to govern Gaza

BY MIRIAM BERGER, HEIDI LEVINE AND SUFIAN TAHA

JENIN, WEST BANK — The black-clad militants of Jenin refugee camp raced through sewage-filled alleyways to dodge gunfire echoing all around. "Quickly," a Palestinian fighter urged as they weaved through a network of armed patrols and improvised barricades. "Watch out," another warned at a juncture where an improvised explosive was being set.

The action witnessed by Washington Post reporters on Dec. 16 could have been the response to an Israeli military raid on this northern West Bank city, the epicenter of a new generation of Palestinian militancy.

But for the past two weeks, the militants of Jenin have been locked in a rare, open battle with an internal foe: the Palestinian Authority.

In Jenin, the authority, which is backed by the West, has launched its largest and most heavily armed operation in its three decades to

SEE WEST BANK ON A10



JOHN MCDONNELL FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Jayden Daniels accounted for 339 yards of offense Sunday in leading the Commanders past the Eagles.

With Daniels, Commanders always in it



Barry Svrluga

Hey, Jayden Daniels. You don't have to stand on the goal line, exhorting the Northwest Stadium crowd to get to its feet. The fans are there with you. You've got them wrapped around your finger. You earned it. Fire them up by thrusting your arms in the air? They're fired up already, brother. For Sunday. And for the

future. The holidays feel different in Washington, now and next year and a decade hence, because Daniels plays for the hometown football team. That was true before Sunday afternoon. But after the final seconds of Sunday's absolutely improbable, he-didn't-just-do-that-did-he 36-33 victory over the hated Philadelphia Eagles, what's clear is this: With Daniels, the Commanders always have a chance. With Daniels,

everything is possible. "If you give him moments, he really lights up in those spots," Commanders Coach Dan Quinn said. "Today, he became a heavy hitter. He really did."

It was just the latest data point. It is now the most important. With his team down by five points and 1 minute 52 seconds remaining — and only a single timeout to spare — Daniels and the Commanders took over at their own 43-yard

SEE SVRLUGA ON A8

Higher costs this year mean less holiday cheer

BY ABHA BHATTARAI

The middle class is paring back on holiday gifts this year, reflecting a widening inflation-fueled spending gap between the country's wealthiest and everyone else.

Americans with annual household incomes of \$40,000 to \$100,000 say they expect to spend 20 percent less on holiday gifts than they did last year, Gallup data shows, even as average household spending is expected to rise. Higher-income families, by comparison, plan to

spend an all-time high of \$1,578 on gifts, a 6 percent increase from last year.

That split is part of a growing divide between higher-income families who are spending big and lower- and middle-income households that are straining to cover basics such as groceries, gas and housing. For many, this holiday season — a time of unbridled spending on nonessentials — has become a tipping point, highlighting just how little they have left over to splurge.

"Everyone likes giving gifts

SEE HOLIDAYS ON A11



NATIONAL ANTHROPOLOGICAL ARCHIVES, SMITHSONIAN INSTITUTION

Thousands died at Indian boarding schools

More than 3,100 Native American students perished at the U.S.-run facilities between 1828 and 1970, three times as many deaths as reported by the government earlier this year. **Special Section**

IN THE NEWS

Pentagon pick Donald Trump named billionaire Stephen Feinberg, who has been involved in defense contracting, as his selection for deputy defense secretary. **A3**

The 'SNAP Gap' For one mother, a county's team-up with Instacart to offer food assistance has been a "tiny, tiny, tiny bit of security." **B1**

THE NATION A majority of Americans oppose Trump's plans to use the military to deport millions of undocumented immigrants, a Washington Post-University of Maryland poll finds. **A3**

THE WORLD Outnumbered Ukrainian troops are clinging to a sliver of Russian territory in Kursk in hopes of using it as a bargaining chip in any future negotiations to end the war. **A9**

THE ECONOMY A coalition of investment firms pledged to spurn funding from China and Russia. **A13**

THE REGION Maryland sued the maker of Gore-Tex, alleging the company knowingly polluted the air and waterways for decades. **B1**

Rayful Edmond III, the notorious D.C. drug kingpin turned informant, hoped to mentor youths as a changed man in a changed city. Last week, that wish died with him. **B1**
Maryland's first deaf community center is slowly becoming closer to a reality. **B1**

STYLE Kerry Washington's new project "The Six Triple Eight," about a heroic Black battalion tasked with delivering mail during World War II, is the latest stop in her life of activism. **C1**
Netflix's "Hot Frosty" is a gloriously ridiculous gift of a movie. **C1**

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